



Jackalope Seems to be Jaunty Enough

Ubuntu 9.04 lives up to its promise of bringing in up-to-date FOSS offerings.

It has not always been a bed of roses for Ubuntu, which has its share of brickbats. And yet, there is something about it that attracts users. It might be the simplicity of not having to decide between multiple editions of the same release. Ubuntu's professional look and feel, coupled with its coherence, could be the reason. It might even be the simplified presentation of a network of technologies. Perhaps it's a bit of all these attractions. Yet, love it or hate it, it remains one of the most popular distributions ever.

Personally, I use it because... well, I have mentioned enough reasons. And so, when version 9.04, the Jaunty Jackalope was released on April 23, I downloaded it the very same day and set about trying it on my new laptop. Here is an account of my (ongoing) experience with Jaunty.

The machine

My laptop, on which I installed Jaunty, is a Dell Inspiron 1545 with the following specs:

- Intel Core 2 Duo 2.0 GHz processor
- 3 GB RAM



Figure 1: The default desktop (live session)

- 320 GB SATA hard disk
- Integrated Intel graphics
- 15.6-inch (39.6 cm) wide screen with a native resolution of 1366x768
- 10/100 Mbps Ethernet port
- Bluetooth and Wi-Fi
- 1.3 mega-pixel Web cam

First impressions

I downloaded the 32-bit version of the live CD (which is bundled with this month's LFY). Booting with the CD revealed the first difference from several preceding releases. The boot splash has changed, replacing the graduated progress bar with a thinner, colour-varied one. Next up, the GDM login screen has also changed, and so has the default wallpaper. Both now look much more professional than the previous ones.

The following is a list of the major goodies included this time:

- Linux 2.6.28
 - GNOME 2.26.1
 - Firefox 3.0.8
 - OpenOffice.org 3.0.1
 - ext4 file system support (the default is still ext3)
 - Amazon EC2-compatible cloud computing support
 - A version specially designed for net books
- ext4 support is one of the major changes hitting distributions these days, but there are still occasional problems like data loss and lockups, so ext3 is the default. A technology called Eucalyptus allows you to set up a cloud computing facility, but it may not be ready for full-time use yet. This time, the Ubuntu team has also created a special version of the operating system for net books.

Apart from this, Brasero is also updated, and a tool called Computer Janitor is included, which is basically a system clean-up utility, capable of removing orphan packages, for